CTI-120 Network and Security Foundation Syllabus

Course Information

Wake Tech Community College - Information Technologies Division - Network Management Department

Course Description:

This course provides a comprehensive introduction to the foundational principles of computer networking. Designed for students pursuing studies in information technology, computer science, or related disciplines, Networking Essentials emphasizes both theoretical understanding and practical application of networking concepts.

Topics include the structure and function of local area networks (LANs), wide area networks (WANs), and the Internet; network devices such as routers, switches, and access points; the OSI and TCP/IP models; IPv4 and IPv6 addressing schemes; and basic routing and switching. Students will also explore wireless networking standards, network security fundamentals, and common diagnostic tools used in troubleshooting.

Hands-on activities using Cisco Packet Tracer and other network simulation tools allow students to develop skills in network design, configuration, and management. Emphasis is placed on real-world problem solving and preparing students for further academic study or industry certifications such as CompTIA Network+ or Cisco Certified Support Technician (CCST).

Upon successful completion, students will be equipped to analyze, configure, and maintain basic network environments, and will understand the critical role networking plays in modern digital infrastructure.

Credit Hours:

Three (3) Semester Hours

Prerequisite:

- Basic computer literacy (file management, use of web browsers, basic troubleshooting)
- Recommended: Introduction to IT or Computer Fundamentals (not mandatory)

Required Software, Technology, and System Requirements

Students enrolled in this course must have regular access to a compatible computer with a reliable high-speed internet connection and the ability to install and run all required course software. Students are responsible for ensuring that their computer, operating system, internet connection, and software meet the requirements necessary to complete course activities, labs, assignments, assessments, and examinations.

Administrative Rights Requirement

Students must have administrative (administrator) rights to the computer they will use for this course. Administrative access is necessary to download, install, update, configure, and troubleshoot required applications and supporting components.
Students using employer-issued, school-managed, or otherwise restricted computers should verify that they have permission to install the required software before beginning the course. A device that prevents the installation or configuration of required applications may not be suitable for completing all course requirements.
Students should verify administrative access and software compatibility before beginning course assignments. Lack of administrative rights, an unsupported operating system, or an inability to install required software does not eliminate the requirement to complete assigned coursework or assessments.

Required Software Tools

Students will use the following software and technology throughout the course:

- **Cisco Packet Tracer.** Version 9.0.1 or the latest course-approved version. Packet Tracer is available as a free download through Cisco Networking Academy (NetAcad) and is used to build, configure, test, and troubleshoot simulated computer networks.
- **Wireshark.** Version 4.6.7 or the latest course-approved stable version. Wireshark is used to capture, inspect, and analyze network traffic and protocols.
- **Certiport Compass.** Current supported version. Compass may be required for certification-related examinations and assessments and must remain updated throughout the course.
- **Web Browser.** Students must have access to a current web browser and a reliable internet connection for Blackboard, NetAcad, course resources, software downloads, assessments, and other web-based activities.
- **PDF Reader.** Students must have software capable of opening and reading PDF documents used throughout the course.
- **Word Processing Software.** Students must have access to word processing software capable of creating and editing course documents, such as Microsoft Word or Google Docs.
- **Screenshot/Snipping Application.** Students must have access to a screenshot or screen-capture application, such as Windows Snipping Tool, Snip & Sketch, macOS Screenshot, or an instructor-approved equivalent. This tool will be used regularly to capture images of completed configurations, command output, application screens, lab results, and other required evidence for submission and grading.

Cisco Packet Tracer

Current Version: Cisco Packet Tracer 9.0.1

Cisco Packet Tracer is a network simulation and visualization application used throughout the course to build, configure, test, and troubleshoot simulated computer networks.

Students should have a computer meeting the current Cisco system requirements, including:

- Supported 64-bit Windows, macOS, or Ubuntu Linux operating system
- 64-bit compatible processor
- Minimum 4 GB RAM
- Approximately 1.4 GB or more of available storage

- Reliable internet access for downloading software, Cisco/NetAcad authentication, and accessing course resources
- Administrative rights necessary to install and configure the application

Packet Tracer should be downloaded only through the official Cisco Networking Academy (NetAcad) Resource Hub. The application is available at no additional cost through NetAcad. Students should use the latest version specified or approved by the instructor.

Wireshark

Current Stable Version: Wireshark 4.6.7

Wireshark is a network protocol analyzer used in this course to capture, inspect, and analyze network traffic and network protocols.

The current Wireshark release supports appropriate versions of Windows, macOS, and Linux/Ubuntu. Windows installations include Npcap, which provides packet-capture functionality necessary for live network traffic analysis.

Because Wireshark and its packet-capture components interact directly with the computer's networking environment, students must have the administrative permissions necessary to install and configure the required software and supporting components.

Students should install the current stable version unless otherwise directed by the instructor.

Certiport Compass

Current Certiport Compass Platform — Windows and Mac versions available

Certiport Compass is locally installed exam-delivery software that may be required for certification-related assessments or examinations associated with this course. Certiport maintains Compass through ongoing software and examination-content updates; therefore, students must ensure that the application is installed, operational, and fully updated before a scheduled testing session.

Students must review Certiport's current technical requirements for their operating system before installation.

Administrative access is required to properly install and configure Compass. Students must therefore ensure that the computer they intend to use for examinations provides the necessary permissions before a scheduled assessment.

Screenshot and Image-Capture Requirements

Many course assignments and labs require students to provide visual evidence of their work for grading. Students must therefore know how to capture, save, locate, and upload screenshots from their computer.

Acceptable tools include:

- Windows Snipping Tool
- Windows Snip & Sketch
- macOS Screenshot
- Other instructor-approved screen-capture applications

Screenshots may be required to document items such as:

- Packet Tracer network topologies and device configurations
- Router and switch CLI commands and command output
- Successful connectivity tests and troubleshooting results
- Wireshark packet captures and protocol analysis
- Configuration settings and application results
- Completion screens or other evidence specifically identified in assignment instructions

Screenshots submitted for grading must be clear, readable, and show all information requested in the assignment instructions. Students are responsible for verifying that the correct image has been captured and successfully uploaded before submitting an assignment.

Unless otherwise instructed, screenshots should be submitted in a commonly supported image format such as PNG or JPG/JPEG. Students should use the file-naming convention specified in the assignment instructions.

A screenshot that is unreadable, incomplete, captures the wrong information, or is not successfully attached to the assignment may not provide sufficient evidence for the work to be graded.

Internet and Web Browser Requirements

A reliable internet connection is required throughout the course. Students will access Blackboard, Cisco Networking Academy/NetAcad, online course materials, assessments, software downloads, and other instructional resources through the internet.

Students should maintain a current version of a mainstream web browser and enable required browser features when directed by course platforms.

Temporary internet interruptions do not change assignment or examination deadlines. Students should plan accordingly and identify an alternative source of reliable internet access when necessary.

PDF Reader and Word Processing Software

Students must have access to software capable of viewing PDF documents and creating, editing, saving, and submitting word-processing documents.

Acceptable tools may include Microsoft Word, Google Docs, Adobe Acrobat Reader, or another instructor-approved application capable of producing the required file format.

Students are responsible for ensuring that submitted documents can be opened and reviewed using the file formats specified in course instructions.

Device Compatibility and Student Responsibility

Students are responsible for ensuring that their computer and operating system are compatible with all required course applications.

Chromebooks, tablets, smartphones, and other mobile or restricted devices should not be considered substitutes for a compatible computer capable of installing and running the full desktop versions of the required course applications. These devices may be useful for accessing Blackboard, reading course materials, or completing limited web-based activities but may not support Packet Tracer, Wireshark, Compass, or other required course functions.

Students should download, install, and test all required applications as early as possible rather than waiting until an assignment or examination is due. Students should also practice taking and uploading screenshots before the first assignment requiring visual documentation.

Software versions and technical requirements may change during the semester as vendors release security, compatibility, or feature updates. When an update is required for course compatibility, students are responsible for installing the required version by the deadline communicated by the instructor.

Student Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of this course, students will be able to:

- Explain the purpose and function of networks, including LANs, WANs, and the Internet.
- Identify and describe basic networking devices (e.g., routers, switches, access points, modems) and their roles in a network.
- Differentiate between common network topologies, protocols, and architectures, such as client-server and peer-to-peer.

- Understand and apply the OSI and TCP/IP models to describe how data moves through a network.
- Describe IPv4 and IPv6 addressing schemes, including subnetting and the role of DNS and DHCP in modern networks.
- Perform basic network configuration tasks, such as assigning IP addresses and connecting devices in a small LAN using Cisco Packet Tracer or similar tools.
- Recognize the principles of wireless networking, including Wi-Fi standards, encryption, and interference issues.
- Apply cybersecurity best practices related to securing a home or small business network.
- Troubleshoot common networking issues using structured methodologies and diagnostic tools (e.g., ping, traceroute, ipconfig).
- Understand career pathways and certifications related to networking, including preparation for entry-level IT support or networking roles.

Course Requirements and/or Expectations

Students enrolled in this course are expected to:

1. Attend all class sessions (or participate fully in online activities if the course is remote/hybrid).
2. Actively participate in discussions, labs, and collaborative work.
3. Complete all assignments, labs, quizzes, and exams by the posted deadlines.
4. Engage in hands-on labs using Packet Tracer to reinforce conceptual understanding with practical skills.
5. Demonstrate academic integrity in all coursework, assessments, and interactions.
6. Take responsibility for seeking help when needed through office hours, discussion forums, or peer study groups.
7. Maintain regular access to course materials and technology tools, including internet and software. Students must have a computing device with a compatible browser (Microsoft Edge, Chrome, Firefox, Safari) to access course eLearning materials and labs.
8. All of the course labs will be completed in the **Cisco Skills-For-All (netacad)** using your @mywaketech.edu email. Any other email will not be accepted.
9. The Skills-For-All curriculum will run on Windows and Apple computers. There are known issues with Chromebooks and are not recommended.
10. Pop-ups, and redirects for the Skills-For-All site and cookies need to be enabled.
11. Antivirus software and firewalls must be disabled to access the final exam application called Compass Browser Lockdown.
12. Many homework assignments in this course require you to use a virtual network simulation software package called Packet Tracer. You are required to download and install on your computer the latest version of Packet Tracer. If you use multiple computers, you may install a copy of Packet Tracer on each computer. The Packet Tracer software is free to Skills-For-All students. In Week 1 of this

course you will be provided information on how to download and install Packet Tracer from Skills-For-All.

13. Online classes will be required to use Packet Tracer Labs for graded labs. Use of Packet Tracer Labs is free to Wake Tech students. Packet Tracer Labs is an environment with "real" Cisco equipment. Students access Packet Tracer Labs via a browser. You will be provided Packet Tracer Labs account and access information in Blackboard.

Textbook

- None

Grading or Evaluation

30% - Lab Assignments
45% - Checkpoint Exams
25% - Final Exam – Cisco Certified Support Technician Networking (CCST)

Course Grading Scale

100-Point-Scale Averages	Final Grade
90 to 100	A
80 to 89	B
70 to 79	C
60 to 69	D
0 to 59	F

Course Overview

Dates my change

Week	Skills-For-All Module	Due Date
Week 1	Module 1,2	Sunday, August 23, 2026 @ 11:59 pm
Week 2	Module 3,4	Sunday, August 30, 2026 @ 11:59 pm
Week 3	Module 5,6,7	Sunday, September 6, 2026 @ 11:59 pm
Week 4	Module 8,9,10,11	Sunday, September 13, 2026 @ 11:59 pm
Week 5	Module 12,13	Sunday, September 20, 2026 @ 11:59 pm
Week 6	Module 14	Sunday, September 27, 2026 @ 11:59 pm
Week 7	Module 16	Sunday, October 4, 2026 @ 11:59 pm

Week 8	Module 15,17	Sunday, October 11, 2026 @ 11:59 pm
Week 9	Module 18,19,20	Sunday, October 18, 2026 @ 11:59 pm
Week 10	Module 21,22,23	Sunday, October 25, 2026 @ 11:59 pm
Week 11	Module 24,25	Sunday, November 1, 2026 @ 11:59 pm
Week 12	Module 26	Sunday, November 8, 2026 @ 11:59 pm
Week 13	Module 27,28,29	Sunday, November 15, 2026 @ 11:59 pm
Week 14	Module 30,31,32	Sunday, November 22, 2026 @ 11:59 pm
Week 15	Module 33,34,35,36	Sunday, November 29, 2026 @ 11:59 pm
Week 16	Module 37,38,39	Sunday, December 6, 2026 @ 11:59 pm

*Some labs have questions and/or table information to answer along with a Packet Tracer lab to complete. For full credit **Submit both for grading.**

Week 1

Lab 1 **Download the version of Packet Tracer**
Lab 2 **1.2.7-packet-tracer-connect-a-network-based-on-a-network-diagram.pka**
Lab 3 **1.0.5-packet-tracer---logical-and-physical-mode-exploration**

Week 2

Lab 1 **4.4.4 Packet Tracer - Configure a Wireless Router and Clients.pka**
Lab 2 **Lab - Explore Social Engineering Techniques.pdf**
Lab 3 **2.5.5-packet-tracer---configure-initial-switch-settings**
Lab 4 **2.7.6-packet-tracer---implement-basic-connectivity**
Checkpoint Exam: Build a Small Network

Week 3

Lab 1 **Wireshark install**
Lab 2 **Lab – Verify Address with a Subnet Calculator.pdf**
Lab 3 **Lab - Determine the MAC Address of a Host.pdf**
Checkpoint Exam: Network Access

Week 4

Lab 1 **8.1.2 Packet Tracer - Connect to a Web Server.pka**
Lab 2 **11.2.3 Packet Tracer - Configure DHCP on a Wireless Router.pka**
Checkpoint Exam: The Internet Protocol

Week 5

Lab 1 **13.1.3 Packet Tracer - Identify MAC and IP Addresses.pka**
Lab 2 **12.2.2 Packet Tracer - Examine NAT on a Wireless Router.pka**

Week 6	
Lab 1	**14.3.3 Packet Tracer - Observe Traffic Flow in a Routed Network.pka**
Lab 2	**14.3.4 Packet Tracer - Create a LAN.pka**
Lab 3	**10.3.4-packet-tracer---connect-a-router-to-a-lan**
	Checkpoint Exam: Communication Between Networks
Week 7	
Lab 1	**16.1.5 Packet Tracer - The Client Interaction.pka**
Lab 2	**16.4.3 Packet Tracer - Observe Web Request.pka**
Lab 3	**16.5.3 Packet Tracer - Use FTP Services.pka**
Lab 4	**16.6.4 Packet Tracer - Use Telnet and SSH.pka**
Week 8	
Lab 1	**17.1.6 Packet Tracer - Use the ping Command.pka**
Lab 2	**17.1.3 Packet Tracer - Use the ipconfig Command.pka**
Lab 3	**2.9.1-packet-tracer---basic-switch-and-end-device-configuration**
	Checkpoint Exam: Protocols for Specific Tasks
Week 9	
Lab 1	**Lab - View Wireless and Wired NIC Information.pdf**
Lab 2	**39.2.13 Packet Tracer - Configure Access Control.pka**
Lab 3	**4.6.5-packet-tracer---connect-a-wired-and-wireless-lan**
	Checkpoint Exam: Characteristics of Network Design
Week 10	
Lab 1	**28.2.4 Packet Tracer - Configure Initial Router Settings.pka**
Lab 2	**Explore_the_Smart_Home_pka.pka**
	Checkpoint Exam: Network Addressing
Week 11	
Lab 1	**24.1.9 Packet Tracer - Examine the ARP Table.pka**
Lab 2	**Lab - View ARP Traffic in Wireshark.pdf**
Week 12	
Lab 1	**26.8.1 Packet Tracer - TCP and UDP Communications.pka**
Lab 2	**28.4.5 Packet Tracer - Troubleshoot Default Gateway Issues.pka**
	Checkpoint Exam: ARP, DNS, DHCP and the Transport Layer
Week 13	
Lab 1	**27.2.6 Packet Tracer - Navigate the IOS.pka**
Lab 2	**27.3.3 Packet Tracer - Use Cisco IOS Show Commands.pka**
Lab 3	**28.1.4 Packet Tracer - Implement Basic Connectivity.pka**
Lab 4	**29.2.7 Packet Tracer - Use Ping and Traceroute to Test Network Connectivity.pka**
Lab 5	**29.3.1 Packet Tracer - Use ICMP to Test and Correct Network Connectivity.pka**
	Checkpoint Exam: Configure Cisco Devices
Week 14	
Lab 1	**36.3.3 Packet Tracer - Troubleshoot a Wireless Connection.pksz**
Lab 2	**39.6.16 Packet Tracer - Configure Basic Wireless Security.pka**
	Checkpoint Exam: Physical, Data Link, and Network Layers
Week 15	

Lab 1	**33.4.6 Packet Tracer - Configure IPv6 Addressing.pka**
Lab 2	**34.1.4 Packet Tracer - IPv6 Neighbor Discovery.pka**
Lab 3	**3.3.12 Packet Tracer - VLAN Configuration.pka**
	Checkpoint Exam: IP Addressing
Week 16	
Lab 1	**37.2.12 Packet Tracer - Use CDP to Map a Network.pka**
Lab 2	**37.2.13 Packet Tracer - Troubleshooting Challenge - Document the Network.pka**
Lab 3	**37.2.7 Packet Tracer - Connect a Network Based on a Network Diagram.pka**
Lab 4	**37.5.6 Packet Tracer - Troubleshooting Challenge - Use Documentation to Solve Issues.pka**
	Check Point Exam: Cisco Devices and Troubleshooting Network Issues
	Final Exam: Certiport

Disability Support Services

Wake Technical Community College does not discriminate based on disability in the admissions or employment processes or access to programs, facilities, or activities. Disability Support Services (DSS) is available for students who require academic accommodations due to physical, psychological, or learning disabilities. Please visit Disability Support Services (opens in new window), URL: [http://disabilityservices.waketech.edu], for additional information. To connect with a DSS coordinator and determine eligibility, contact the Main campus at Phone: 919-866-5670 (Sorenson video phone for the deaf: 919-324-1508). Fax: 919-662-3616. Or, contact the North campus office at Phone: 919-532-5713. Fax: 919-878-1896.

FINAL EXAM Disability Accommodation Request Process

1. Log in or create your account: https://certiport.onhgcloud.com/
2. Once you have logged in to the system, you may request accommodations by clicking on the "Start A New Request Here" button and following the directions in the request system.
3. The final step (step 6) will require you to upload supporting documentation.
4. After you have uploaded the necessary documents, click the "Submit" button at the bottom of the page. You will receive an email from the system notifying you that your request has been submitted.
5. **Please allow 10 business days for us to review your materials.**
6. After your request has been reviewed, you will receive an email to notify you that a determination has been made. The determination letter will appear on step 6 of your request in the "My Documents" section.

Please note that step 5 says it could take up to ten business days before approved.

FINAL EXAM Scoring

Certiport Exam Points	Final Exam Grade Equivalent
700 or Higher	100% (certification achieved)
699 – 600	90% (certification **NOT** achieved)
599 – 500	80% (certification **NOT** achieved)
499 – 400	70% (certification **NOT** achieved)
Below 400	60% (certification **NOT** achieved)
Not Taken at All	0%

Wake Tech Core Values

Wake Technical Community College will structure its operations, training, and educational programs around the Core Values of accountability, respect, responsibility, critical thinking, communication, and collaboration.

- **Accountability**—Accountability is essential for an environment of learning. Those who are accountable stand by their words and actions, taking full responsibility for what they create and contributing to the community.
- **Respect**—Respect is a prerequisite for enhancing learning. Community members who respect themselves and others help create a safe yet open climate of learning.
- **Responsibility**—Responsibility is the root of success. Students who assume personal responsibility for their education will reach their goals. Responsible students also make contributions to their communities.
- **Critical Thinking**—Critical thinking is the fundamental purpose of higher education. The ability to solve problems through the application of the appropriate skills is vital to all disciplines.
- **Communication**—Communication is increasingly the key competency for living and working in the information age. Communicating effectively in oral and written forms through traditional and new media is a powerful tool for personal and career success.
- **Collaboration**—Collaboration creates teams that are greater than the sum of their parts. Such teamwork maximizes benefits to individuals and the community.

Policies

Students are responsible for reading the information and policies outlined in the Wake Technical Community College catalog (opens in new window), URL: [http://catalog.waketech.edu], and additional requirements set by the instructor. Students are held accountable for this information. New policies and policy changes will

be communicated to students on the official Updates page (opens in new window), URL: [http://Updates.waketech.edu].

Communication etiquette

Students are expected to communicate in clear, correct, respectful Standard American English at all times. This includes all online or electronic communication, which should follow the standards of Internet etiquette (also known as "netiquette"). Students unfamiliar with these concepts and conventions should check with their instructors.

Attendance Policy

The college catalog student handbook states that "students are expected to be in attendance at least 90 percent of all scheduled class meetings. An absence is defined as missing one-third or more of any regularly scheduled class meeting." If you anticipate an absence, notify your instructor in advance. "If prior notification is not possible, the student should contact the instructor immediately upon returning to the college to determine the next course of action."

Absences due to religious holidays–The college catalog states that "Wake Tech students are allowed two class days of excused absences per academic year for religious observances. It is the student's responsibility to contact the instructor for each course in which work will be missed. The student must provide written notification to the instructor within the first two weeks of the semester, identifying the religious observance and date of the planned absence."

Days missed for religious observances will be counted as absences, but they will not be considered part of the allowed 10%. Reasonable accommodations will be made for affected students in regards to any resulting missed work.

Verification of Attendance in Online or Hybrid Courses--In order to remain enrolled in an online or hybrid course, each student is required to open and complete the Course Entry Quiz in Blackboard by 11:59 PM on the semester 10% date. Students should complete the activity as soon as possible. Delay in completion may result in getting behind in coursework or in missing assignments.

Students who do not complete the Course Entry Quiz by the deadline will be dropped from the course with no tuition refund.

Packet Tracer Lab Submission Requirement

For all Packet Tracer lab assignments in CTI-120, students are required to submit both of the following items by the posted deadline:

1. The completed Packet Tracer lab file saved with the student's last name preceding the file name.
   Example: LastName1.2.7.Packet-tracer-how-to-do-something.pka

2. A screenshot showing the lab completion percentage in Packet Tracer while also displaying the student's name from their Blackboard profile. This screenshot serves as verification that the submitted work belongs to the student.

Failure to submit both required items will result in an automatic deduction. If a student submits the screenshot but does not submit the actual Packet Tracer .pka file, the grade earned from the lab completion percentage will be reduced by 50%. If a student submits the .pka file but does not submit the required screenshot showing the completion percentage and Blackboard name, the assignment will receive an automatic 50% deduction.
Some labs also include highlighted or specifically identified questions that must be answered and submitted as part of the assignment. These questions are not optional. If a lab requires written responses and the student fails to submit those answers, the assignment will receive an automatic zero, regardless of the Packet Tracer completion percentage or submitted files.
Students are responsible for verifying that all required files and responses are attached and successfully submitted before the deadline. Submitting only one portion of the assignment, submitting the wrong file, omitting required written answers, submitting a file without the required naming format, or failing to provide proof of ownership may result in point deductions, a zero, and/or additional review under the course academic integrity policy. Late corrections, replacement files, or additional uploads after grading are not guaranteed to be accepted.

Late Work Policy

Each project/assignment/exercise will come with specific instructions for completion. All studio/class work MUST be completed (if applicable)! It is your responsibility throughout the semester to keep up with your course work. It is not the responsibility of the instructor to advise you of missed work during the term or on the last week of the term.

Exams must be taken on the assigned date; otherwise a grade of zero will be assigned. Any exception to this policy must be the result of a documented emergency or prior arrangement with the instructor. There will be no exceptions to this rule.
ANY MAKEUP EXAMS must be taken prior to the scheduled exam date. This must be pre-arranged with the instructor. Last minute arrangements are not acceptable.

Plagiarism and Academic Integrity Policy

All work submitted in CTI-120 must be your own original work and must reflect your personal understanding of the course material. Plagiarism includes, but is not limited to, copying another student's work, submitting work completed by someone else, using unauthorized files or answers from another course section, copying online solutions, sharing Packet Tracer files or screenshots, submitting AI-generated responses without instructor permission, or presenting any outside work as your own. Collaboration may

be encouraged during learning activities, but submitted assignments, labs, exams, quizzes, reflections, and projects must represent your own effort unless group work is explicitly assigned by the instructor.
Any suspected violation of academic integrity may result in a grade of zero for the lab assignment, check point exam, or final exam, and may be reported in accordance with Wake Tech's academic integrity and student conduct policies. Repeated or serious violations may result in additional disciplinary action. Students are responsible for verifying that they are working in the correct course shell, submitting the correct files, and ensuring that all work is completed honestly and independently. Misunderstanding, last-minute confusion, or submitting work from another source will not excuse a violation.

Extra Credit

This course has been intentionally designed with a fair and transparent point system that reflects the learning objectives and aligns with the institution's academic integrity policies. All assignments, assessments, and participation opportunities have been carefully structured to provide students with multiple ways to demonstrate mastery of the material.

As such, extra credit will not be offered under **any** circumstances. Students are strongly encouraged to stay engaged, meet all deadlines, and seek support early if they encounter challenges. Maintaining the integrity and equity of the grading process is essential to ensuring that all students are evaluated fairly and consistently.

Official Communication with Students Policy

Every curriculum student is provided with an official Wake Tech email account through the Wake Tech student portal (opens in new window), URL: [http://my.waketech.edu].

- Students must first activate their my.waketech.edu account, wait 24 hours, and then activate the email account.
- This college-issued email account is to be used for all email correspondence with instructors and other college officials.

Official correspondence from the college (communications from instructors, information about registration or financial aid, etc.) will be sent to students' Wake Tech email address **ONLY**. Instructors and college officials may refuse to accept student emails sent from other addresses. Review the Registration and Records section in Wake Tech's catalog (opens in new window), URL: [http://catalog.waketech.edu], for updates to the Official Communication with Students Policy.

FERPA Statement

Review the Academic Policies section of Wake Tech's catalog (opens in new window), URL: [http://catalog.waketech.edu], for updates.

Following the *Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act* (FERPA) *of 1974*, instructors are prohibited from discussing a student's grade or other matters related to academic performance outside of the Blackboard grade center. Faculty may send grades to individual students via email only when written authorization from the student is on file (WTCC Form 1126).

The Authorization to Release Instructor Graded Material (WTCC Form 1126) does not apply to final grades. Final grades will be accessed through WebAdvisor only or with a Request for Transcript.

Students may request this form from the instructor.

Wake Technical Community College Academic Integrity Policy

"Wake Technical Community College expects students to demonstrate the highest personal integrity in all academic work and behavior…. Students may be asked to sign a statement of academic integrity upon entering Wake Tech classes." Review the Student Code of Conduct, Rights, and Responsibilities section of Wake Tech's catalog (opens in new window), URL: [http://catalog.waketech.edu], for additional information.

Student Code of Conduct

"Students are expected to conduct themselves in accordance with generally-accepted standards of scholarship and conduct. The purpose of the Student Code of Conduct (the Student Code) is not to restrict student freedom but to protect the rights of all students in their academic pursuits." Review the Student Code of Conduct, Rights, and Responsibilities section of Wake Tech's catalog (opens in new window), URL: [http://catalog.waketech.edu], for additional information.